Gísli Gylfason

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Primary — Political Economy, Media Economics
Secondary — Applied Microeconomics

EDUCATION

Paris School of Economics & EHESS *Paris, France*
Ph.D. in Economics 2022 – early 2027 (expected)
Advisor: Ekaterina Zhuravskaya
Thesis: *Essays in the Political Economy of the Internet and Social Media*

Princeton University *Princeton, NJ, USA*
Visiting Ph.D. Student, Department of Politics 2024 – 2025
Host: Jacob N. Shapiro

Paris School of Economics & EHESS *Paris, France*
M.Sc. in Economics (Public Policy and Development) 2020 – 2022
Highest Honours (summa cum laude)

University of Iceland *Reykjavík, Iceland*
B.Sc. in Economics 2016 – 2019
Top of class, with distinction (9.03/10)

JOB MARKET PAPER

Doomscrolling: TikTok and News Consumption

Abstract: How does TikTok use affect news consumption and downstream political outcomes? Leveraging detailed device-level mobile browsing and app use data and a shock to early adoption of TikTok as a novel, plausibly exogenous source of variation, I estimate the causal effect of TikTok use on news consumption, political knowledge, attitudes and behavior in the United States. I find that increased TikTok use substantially reduces news consumption related to major news events such as elections, national disasters and major political developments. TikTok use reduces news consumption along both the extensive and intensive margins. It also reduces the length of individuals' news consumption sessions, suggesting that reduced attention spans contribute to the effect. Survey evidence shows that the effect is not limited to mobile devices and has downstream consequences: individuals in high-TikTok-use media markets have lower traditional news consumption, political knowledge and turnout, and higher partisan polarization in presidential approval after, but not before, TikTok's proliferation.

WORKING PAPERS

Twitter's Effect on Mental Health: Evidence from Population-Scale U.S. Insurance Data, 2006–2020
(with D. Baseman, G. Bushnell, K. J. Dolinski, D. B. Horton, D. Kosenkov, M. Kumar, E. Sisay, O. G. Troyanskaya, E. Zhuravskaya and J. N. Shapiro)
Under review. Draft available upon request.

Short abstract: Linking population-scale U.S. public and private insurance claims to a shock to early Twitter adoption, we find that Twitter penetration raised claims for anxiety, depression and eating disorders from 2011 onward.

From Tweets to the Streets: Twitter and Extremist Protests in the United States

Short abstract: Twitter raised the frequency of U.S. protests and disproportionately fuelled those involving extreme groups, on both the political left and the right.

WORK IN PROGRESS

The Political Effects of Russian TV Propaganda in the Baltics (with V. Eliseeva and E. Zhuravskaya)
Summary: Using the 2022 ban on Russian state television in Estonia and Latvia, this project studies how losing access to propaganda affects voting behaviour.

PRE-PHD PUBLICATIONS

A Natural Experiment in Education Reform: The Case of Upper-Secondary Curriculum Compression (with T. L. Ásgeirsdóttir and G. Zoega), *The Manchester School*, 93(4), 319–367, 2025.

Monetizing Utility Reductions Associated with Bullying (with T. L. Ásgeirsdóttir, A. Hauksdóttir, E. B. Þórðardóttir and U. A. Valdimarsdóttir), *Journal of Happiness Studies*, 24(8), 2395–2439, 2023.

Gender Differences in Iceland's Education System (with G. Zoega), *Tímarit um uppeldi og menntun / Icelandic Journal of Education*, 30(2), 135–165, 2021.

SEMINARS AND CONFERENCES

2026 CEPR Paris Symposium (poster session)*; CESifo Workshop on Digital Platforms: Methods, Policy and Politics (University of Warwick); Applied Economics Lunch Seminar (PSE); GPET Internal Seminar (PSE)

2024 CESifo Venice Summer Institute: The Economics of Social Media; Political Economy Research Seminar (Princeton); ESOC Lab Meeting (Princeton); NePE Workshop (Paris 1 Panthéon-Sorbonne); Public Governance Working Group (Paris Dauphine); GPET Internal Seminar (PSE)

2023 2nd Academic Workshop for Icelandic Economists Abroad (University of Iceland); Applied Economics Lunch Seminar (PSE); GPET Internal Seminar (PSE)

2019 Þjóðarspegillinn: Conference in Social Science (University of Iceland), Icelandic Ministry of Education, Science and Culture

* Scheduled

GRANTS AND AWARDS

Project Grant, Icelandic Research Fund (Rannsóknasjóður, Rannís), ISK 76m (approx. EUR 535,000). Co-proposer with T. L. Ásgeirsdóttir and G. Zoega (PI); funds a three-year postdoctoral position — 2026

Landsbankinn Scholarship for PhD studies, awarded to students judged likely to enrich Icelandic society — 2025

International Mobility Grant, Paris School of Economics, for a research visit to Princeton University — 2024

Campus France Scholarship, Ambassade de France en Islande, for master's studies — 2022

Icelandic Student Innovation Fund, for work on upper-secondary schooling length and university achievement — 2019

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching assistant, Paris School of Economics (master's level)

Introduction to Political Economy (M1) — 2023, 2024

Political Economy 2: Conflict, Institutions, Media and Governance (M2) — 2022, 2023

Teaching assistant, University of Iceland (bachelor's level)

Macroeconomics 2 — 2018, 2019

Microeconomics 2 — 2019

Mathematics for Economic Analysis 1, 2 and 3 — 2018, 2019

Overall evaluation scores at the University of Iceland ranged from 8.5 to 9.5 out of 10, against a faculty average of about 7.5.

RELEVANT WORK EXPERIENCE

OECD, Centre on Well-being, Inclusion, Sustainability and Equal Opportunity (WISE) 2021
Summer intern — effects of COVID-19 on well-being *Paris, France*

SKILLS

Coding & software R, Python (incl. PySpark), Stata, LaTeX, QGIS
Languages Icelandic (native), English (fluent), French and Danish (basic)

ADDITIONAL TRAINING

ETH Zürich *Zürich, Switzerland*
Summer School and Workshop on Artificial Intelligence in Economics Sept. 2026

REFERENCES

Ekaterina Zhuravskaya (Advisor)
Professor of Economics
Paris School of Economics
ezhuravskaya@gmail.com

Jacob N. Shapiro
Professor of Politics and International Affairs
Princeton University
jns@princeton.edu

Oliver Vanden Eynde
Professor of Economics
Paris School of Economics
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